

Eastern Himalayan Forest

A wealth of trees growing in the world's highest mountain range, supporting a wide variety of plant and animal life



The eastern Himalayas region is characterized chiefly by temperate broadleaf evergreen and deciduous forests. These cover an area of about 32,000 square miles (83,000 square km) at altitudes of 6,600–10,000 ft (2,000–3,000 m) and stretch from central Nepal eastward through Bhutan into northeast India.

Plant treasury

This is an ecoregion rich in plant life, where tree type varies according to altitude and geography. In the temperate evergreen forests, oaks and other trees such as magnolia and cinnamon grow alongside thickets of rhododendrons—some areas, such as Bhutan, may contain up to 60 species of rhododendrons alone. Temperate deciduous forest areas are dominated by maples, birches, and walnuts, which give way to magnolias and maples in the wetter eastern reaches of Nepal, together with more tropical shrubs such as schefflera and pockets of bamboo. At least 125 mammal species are found in the ecoregion, including some, such as the Namdapha flying squirrel, that live nowhere else in the world. Threatened species include the stump-tailed macaque and clouded leopard.



▷ FLORAL DISPLAY

Rhododendron blooms dot south-facing slopes, where they flourish alongside oaks, epiphytic orchids, ferns, and mosses.

▽ RAINBOW PLUMAGE

The Himalayan monal pheasant is one of around 500 bird species that live in the forest. The iridescent male is the national bird of Nepal.



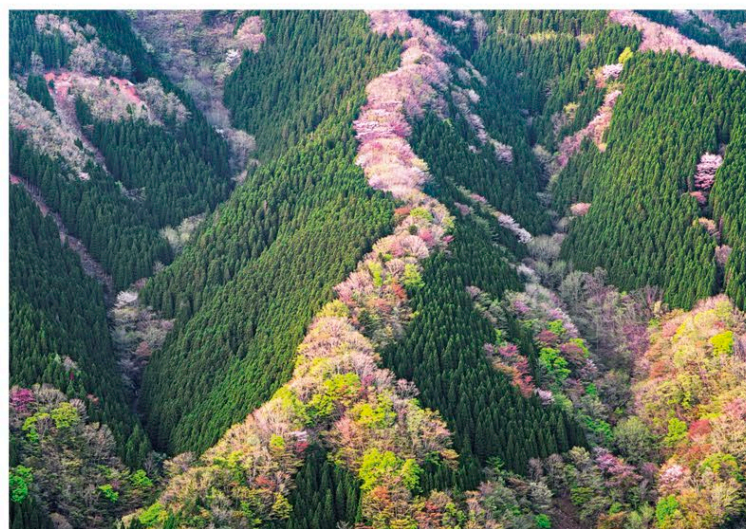
Taiheiyo Montane Forest

High and hilly, one of Japan's seven forest ecoregions, covering parts of three islands with both broadleaf and fir trees



Hardy deciduous trees mixed with firs and bamboo characterize Taiheiyo montane forest. Running along the Pacific side of Japan's main island of Honshu, as well as Shikoku and Kyushu islands, this temperate ecoregion covers an area of about 16,200 square miles (42,000 square km).

In this forest, the climate is humid all year round, but trees must withstand sharp seasonal temperature changes. Winters are cold and snowy, with average temperatures below freezing, but during summer, they rise to 77°F (25°C) or more. Beech and fir are dominant species, growing alongside maple and oak, with an understory of sasa, a type of dwarf bamboo. The forest's seeds, nuts, and bark provide food for mammals such as the Asiatic black bear and sika deer, and birds such as the Oriental white-eye, all of which help replenish the forest by dispersing seeds.



◁ PINK TRAILS

The Taiheiyo's beech and maple trees are joined in some areas by other hardwoods such as oaks and Japanese cherries, which stand out against pockets of firs.